



Creating measurable impact at the

Grassroots



www.rootsfoundation.in







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Introduction

Roots Foundation was established with a vision to understand and fulfil the aspirations of the lesser privileged by conceptualising and implementing bottom-up interventions in Sustainable Agriculture, Sports, Education, Healthcare, Skilling and Community Development.

OUR MISSION

***To create an equitable society** where all individuals, regardless of who they are and where they come from, get a chance to learn, build skills, and, in turn, secure dignified livelihoods.*

OUR VISION

***To empower grassroots communities** through effective execution of agriculture, sports, education, and skill development initiatives—delivering measurable, sustained impact,*

CORE VALUES



Integrity: We maintain transparency and trust in every relationship—with communities, donors, and partners.



Empathy: We listen deeply, respect local realities, and co-create solutions with the communities we serve.



Impact First: Our work is guided by measurable social returns and sustainable change.



Ownership Mindset: Our deep commitment and ownership mindset ensure that every initiative we undertake is not just initiated but sustained with accountability.

Founders



Ritwik Bahuguna



Ridhima Bahuguna

At Roots Foundation, we have always believed that true change begins at the grassroots. This year has reaffirmed that belief, as communities themselves stepped forward, not just as participants, but as co-creators of transformation.

What makes our approach different is how we build every solution for communities, with their equal participation. We start by listening and understanding their realities, aspirations, and challenges and then co-design interventions that truly belong to them. Only after this process do we seek partnerships and funding to bring these solutions to life.

Our focus has always been on creating programs that endure. We work with our partners to ensure that each initiative runs for at least three to four years, long enough to build local capacity, enable behaviour change, and ensure that the project becomes self-reliant and its impact continues well beyond our exit.

In Sustainable Agriculture, our work now spans more than 96,000 acres, but what matters most is the mindset shift, farmers choosing to adopt Direct Seeding of Rice and crop residue management because they have witnessed their neighbours save costs, conserve water, and inspire entire clusters to give up burning.

In Sports, over 10,000 children have been engaged across our programs. The real success lies not in medals alone, but in the fact that leagues like the Veer Champions League are helping children stay in school, while barefoot athletes in Jharkhand are competing at national arenas, carrying with them the pride of their villages.

In Education and Skilling, the progress has been equally profound. Through programs like LEAP and Unnati, young people are building confidence, finding direction, and redefining what empowerment means, not just in livelihoods, but in dignity, voice, and independence.

Our Community Development programs continue to strengthen local systems through healthcare, scholarships, digital literacy, and livelihoods, each effort reinforcing that empowerment is not delivered; it is nurtured until communities take ownership and lead.

This year, we also strengthened our monitoring and evaluation systems by onboarding independent experts from the industry. Regardless of donor mandates, we are getting our projects third-party assessed against best-practice frameworks because transparency and accountability are integral to how we measure change.

Across all our states of work, we are also deepening collaboration with state governments to align our programs with public systems, ensuring that behaviour change and continuity go hand in hand. As Roots Foundation continues to grow as a trusted development partner, our greatest achievement remains the same: when a community no longer needs us, because it has found the strength, skills, and systems to sustain its own progress.

– Ridhima & Ritwik Bahuguna
Founders, Roots Foundation

Our Journey

Founded in 2012, Roots Foundation began with a simple conviction that lasting change must grow from the grassroots. What started as a small, founder-funded initiative has today evolved into a multi-sector organisation working across agriculture, education, sports, skill development, and community empowerment.

2014 – Launched our first on-ground program in Delhi NCR, engaging directly with schools and communities at the grassroots level.

2016 – Initiated our first agriculture extension program with farmers in Haryana and Rajasthan, marking the beginning of our work in sustainable agriculture and climate-resilient livelihoods.

2012–2018 – Operated as a bootstrapped, founder-funded initiative, guided by a commitment to create tangible, people-led change.

2018 – Secured our first CSR funding, expanding our capacity to scale community impact.

2020 – Established an independent office in the heart of Gurugram, strengthening operational capacity and outreach.

2021 – Formally registered as a Section 8 not-for-profit company, institutionalising our mission and governance framework.

2018–2025 – Partnered with 15+ leading corporates and institutions across sectors such as sustainable agriculture, grassroots sports, education, and livelihoods, building long-term programs rooted in impact and accountability.

Over the years, Roots Foundation has grown from a small grassroots initiative to a trusted development partner, enabling communities to adopt sustainable practices, empowering women and youth, and fostering collaboration between people, business, and purpose.

Our Strategic Focus

Roots Foundation is positioned as a **'trusted partner'** of **governments** and **corporates** to deliver **strategic solutions** and undertake robust **implementation** for **grassroots** development/welfare projects.

We specialise in last-mile execution to ensure sustained and measurable change at the grassroots.



Community-Centric Approach

Honouring local knowledge and voices.



Scalability, Integrity & Scalability

Building scalable models that can be replicated without compromising authenticity.



Partnership-Driven Impact

Co-creating and Co-funding solutions with donors, governments, and communities.

Our Impact

10 Lakh+

farmers trained in sustainable agricultural practices



15,000+

budding sportspersons get a platform to shine each year



5,000+

women and youth provided employment-linked skilling every year



8,000+

school children benefitted with improved learning & retention levels, and career counselling



60,000+

rural & urban poor given basic preventive & curative healthcare annually



Roots Foundation & the SDGs

The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) are the global blueprint to end poverty, protect the planet, and ensure prosperity for all by 2030. They are universal and interlinked, cutting across people, planet, and prosperity.

Roots Foundation's programmes align strongly with the SDGs on education, health, gender, livelihoods, sustainable production, climate action, water, biodiversity, inclusive communities, and partnerships.

In practice, this means connecting everyday actions, keeping a child in school, training a woman for dignified work, helping a farmer adopt crop-residue management. to global targets on quality education (SDG 4), decent work (SDG 8), responsible consumption and production (SDG 12), and climate action (SDG 13), among others.

Roots Focus	Primary SDGs	What this looks like in our programmes
Sustainable Agriculture	SDG 12 – Responsible Consumption & Production SDG 13 – Climate Action SDG 6 – Clean Water SDG 15 – Life on Land	Crop Residue Management (in-situ/ex-situ), Direct Seeding of Rice (water & energy savings), soil health and biodiversity, market linkages for residue—advancing circular, low-emission production and resilience.
Education (LEAP, Utkarsh)	SDG 4 – Quality Education SDG 5 – Gender Equality	Foundational literacy & numeracy, STEM & digital learning, life skills, career guidance, library ecosystems; improved retention and gender-equitable attitudes aligned to SDG 4 targets on inclusive, equitable learning.
Sports (VCL, Sports Lab, Sports for All)	SDG 3 – Good Health & Well-being SDG 4 – Quality Education SDG 5 – Gender Equality SDG 10 – Reduced Inequalities	School-embedded sport, leagues and life-skills that boost health, engagement and retention; equal opportunities for girls and underserved children.
Skill Development (Unnati)	SDG 8 – Decent Work & Economic Growth, SDG 5 – Gender Equality, SDG 10 – Reduced Inequalities	Market-linked training, placements, micro-enterprise support for women and youth—expanding productive employment and dignified incomes.
Community Development (CDP)	SDG 1 – No Poverty, SDG 3 – Health, SDG 6 – Clean Water & Sanitation, SDG 11 – Sustainable Communities, SDG 16 – Inclusive Institutions	Rural clinics, scholarships, digital literacy, sanitation & basic infrastructure, SHGs and local governance mechanisms (Bal Sansad, community committees) that build inclusive, resilient communities.
Partnerships & M&E	SDG 17 – Partnerships for the Goals	Long-horizon CSR collaborations (3–4 years), alignment with state systems, independent M&E/third-party assessments—strengthening transparency and multi-stakeholder impact.

Presence

We are a Pan-India Organization

20 States

100+ Districts

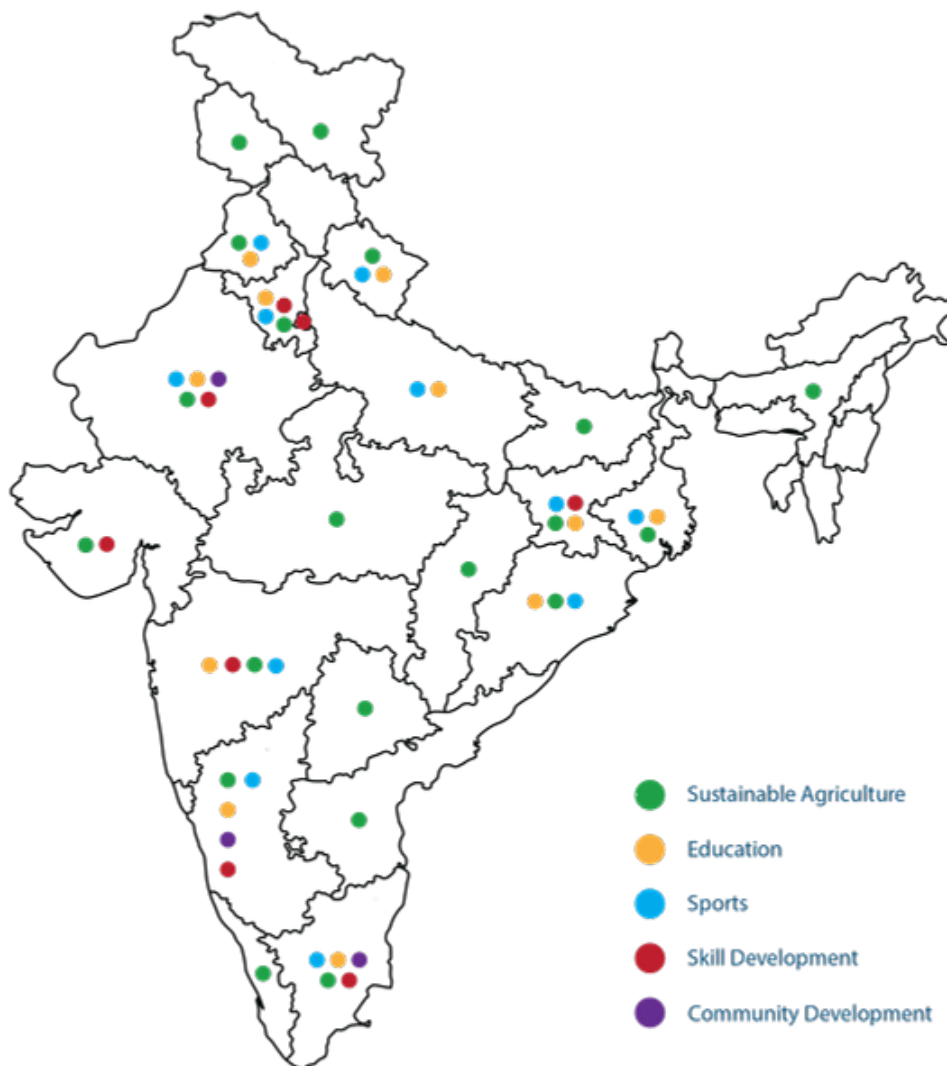
8 Office Locations

100+ team members



Our Office Locations

- Delhi NCR
- Hisar
- Kota
- Surat
- Bengaluru
- Ranchi
- Kolkata
- Mayurbhanj



Highlights of the year

जड़ों से

| Our work



Sustainable Agriculture

Our initiatives in sustainable agricultural practices help farmers reduce the production cost, increase output and sell produce directly to retailers or processors through better use of available techniques and technologies.



+10,00,000
farmers' income enhanced



+15
state presence



“We have to transform India in five areas where India has core competence, first being Agriculture”

Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam



Why it Matters

Agriculture remains the backbone of India's economy, yet it is under mounting pressure from multiple fronts, soil degradation, resource scarcity, climate stress and environmental externalities. Approximately 30 % of India's land is now degraded, threatening both productivity and food security. In many regions, soil health concerns are acute: fewer than 5 % of soils have adequate nitrogen levels, and fertiliser efficiency has dropped from 1:10 in the 1970s to just 1:2.7 today.

Meanwhile, crop-residue burning remains a serious concern: for example, in Delhi the contribution of stubble burning to PM_{2.5} pollution reached over 30 % at times during the late 2024 season. In Punjab, ex-situ management of over 6.2 million tonnes of paddy straw in 2024 helped reduce fire incidents by around 70 % in that state alone.

These interconnected challenges, soil deterioration, inefficient mechanisation, environmentally harmful post-harvest practices and exposure to climate risk, place millions of small and marginal farmers at risk of declining incomes and unsustainable livelihoods. At the same time, they affect water security, air quality and ecosystem health. This is why sustainable agriculture is not just about increasing yields, it is about restoring balance among people, planet and production; enabling farmers to thrive economically while preserving the natural capital they depend on.

Our Focus Areas

Our approach to sustainable agriculture integrates technology, training, and community-driven innovation across the following focus areas:

- **Productivity Enhancement** – Improving yields and profitability through sustainable inputs, scientific agronomy, and access to modern tools.
- **Resource & Environmental Conservation** – Promoting soil health, precision nutrient management, and reduced chemical use to restore natural balance.
- **Optimal Use of Technology** – Leveraging farm mechanisation, digital tools, and remote advisory systems for efficient and informed decision-making.
- **Market Linkages & Value Chain Development** – Strengthening farmer–market connections through partnerships with FPOs, End-User Industries, and Custom Hiring Centres.
- **Climate Resilience** – Encouraging adaptive practices like Direct Seeding of Rice, crop diversification, and drought-tolerant varieties to mitigate risk.
- **Integrated Farming Systems** – Promoting mixed cropping, livestock integration, and agro-forestry for income diversification and ecosystem health.
- **Crop Residue Management (CRM)** – Reducing stubble burning through in-situ and ex-situ solutions, mechanisation, and residue monetisation.
- **Capacity Building & Farmer Training** – Organising farmer field schools, awareness campaigns, and exposure visits to drive large-scale adoption.
- **Water Management** – Supporting efficient irrigation methods, rainwater harvesting, and practices that enhance water-use efficiency.
- **Policy Advocacy & Awareness** – Working with government and industry stakeholders to influence adoption of sustainable models and policies.
- **Biodiversity Conservation** – Encouraging practices that preserve on-farm biodiversity and promote ecological stability.
- **Post-Harvest Management** – Enabling farmers to reduce losses, add value, and access better markets through improved storage and processing.



Project Sahyog

Project Sahyog is a large-scale farm mechanisation and knowledge-transfer initiative implemented across Haryana, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, and Uttarakhand. The program equips farmers with Tractor-Mounted and Self-Propelled Boom Sprayers (TMS & SPBS), promotes the judicious use of agrochemicals, and fosters entrepreneurship by enabling beneficiaries to rent out equipment to their peers. Through a blend of training, demonstrations, and IEC campaigns, the project strengthens farm productivity, reduces input costs, and creates sustainable income streams for rural communities

Objectives

- Facilitate access to advanced spraying machinery for small and marginal farmers.
- Promote safe and judicious use of agrochemicals to protect soil health and farmer well-being.
- Develop rural entrepreneurs by gifting/leasing machines and enabling rental-based income generation.
- Reduce labour dependency and enhance timely application of crop protection measures.
- Build awareness through IEC campaigns and village-level farmer meetings.

Major Activities

- Partnered with MITRA, Charlie, Shaktiman, and Escorts after rigorous quality checks.
- Delivered 45 Tractor-Mounted Sprayers (TMS) and 10 Self-Propelled Boom Sprayers (SPBS).
- Conducted 150+ farmer meetings, field demonstrations, and hands-on training sessions.
- Designed and disseminated IEC material in local languages (pamphlets, wall paintings, banners).
- Conducted baseline and endline surveys to measure knowledge improvement and adoption.

Location(s)

PUNJAB, HARYANA, UTTARAKHAND, UTTAR PRADESH



Key Highlights & Outcomes

- 55 boom sprayers deployed across four states, covering 24,815 acres in a single season.
- ~13,000 farmers reached directly and indirectly through training and demonstrations.
- Revenue generation of ₹36 lakh through TMS rental and ₹19 lakh through SPBS rental.
- 83% of beneficiaries accessed services below market rate, saving up to 50% on spraying costs.
- Strengthened alignment with SDG 1 (No Poverty), SDG 8 (Decent Work & Economic Growth), and SDG 12 (Responsible Consumption & Production).

Important Data & Numbers

- 55 Boom Sprayers distributed (45 TMS + 10 SPBS)
- Coverage: 125 villages across 4 states
- 1972 Direct Beneficiaries + 11,000+ sensitized farmers
- 24,815 Acres covered in a single season
- ₹55+ Lakh Revenue generated by farmer-entrepreneurs
- 150+ Farmer Meetings conducted across 125 villages in 4 states

Stories of Change

Anil Kumar – From Farmer to Agri-Entrepreneur

Anil Kumar, a small farmer from Haryana, received a Tractor-Mounted Sprayer under Project Sahyog. In just one season, he covered 900 acres for fellow farmers, charging ₹200 per acre and earning ₹1.8 lakh. His affordable service helped neighbours reduce spraying costs by nearly 50% while ensuring timely crop protection. Anil has now become a local resource person for machine maintenance, inspiring others in the village to explore agri-entrepreneurship.

Satpal Vikas Samiti Cooperative Society

This society in Punjab leased out their Self-Propelled Boom Sprayer and covered 1,854 acres, generating ₹4.7 lakh in a single season while charging below market rates. Their success proves that collective ownership of modern machinery can enhance income while ensuring wider community benefit.





Project Harit Samriddhi (CIL)

Project Harit Samriddhi is an integrated sustainable agriculture program implemented in Tandwa and Simariya blocks of Chatra district, Jharkhand. The initiative focuses on natural resource conservation, farmer capacity building, crop diversification, and income enhancement through demonstration-based learning and certified training. It creates climate-resilient rural livelihoods by combining water-efficient practices, soil health management, and market-oriented interventions.

Objectives

- Build capacity of farmers, especially women, through Agriculture Skill Council of India (ASCI)-certified trainings.
- Establish model farms and demonstration plots showcasing sustainable agriculture practices.
- Increase farmer incomes through crop diversification, better input use efficiency, and market linkages.
- Promote climate-smart practices such as drip irrigation, mulching, and natural pest management.
- Facilitate livelihood diversification through mushroom cultivation and vermicomposting.

Major Activities

- Conducted basic training for 2,044 farmers (70.6% women), covering soil testing, composting, crop diversification, and market linkages.
- Established 75 demonstration plots (target was 60) for mustard, chickpea, and garden pea, showing significant yield improvements.
- Developed a 1-acre model farm with drip irrigation, mulching, natural pest control, and polyhouse vegetable farming.
- Organised 25 Farmer Field School (FFS) batches with 700 participants for hands-on learning.
- Conducted baseline survey with 872 farmers to assess current practices and adoption readiness.
- Supported vermicomposting units and conducted mushroom & vermicompost interest surveys with 206 farmers (95% women).
- Provided input kits and facilitated exposure visits for over 2,000 farmers to model plots.

Location(s)

PUNJAB, HARYANA, ANDHRA PRADESH, JAMMU & KASHMIR, RAJASTHAN, BIHAR, CHHATTISGARH, KARNATAKA, TAMIL NADU, WEST BENGAL



Key Highlights & Outcomes

- 70.6% women participation ensured gender-inclusive development.
- 75 demo plots led to measurable income rise: Mustard (+64%), Chickpea (+69.5%), Garden Pea (+69%).
- Model farm demonstrated 30% water savings (drip irrigation) and 25–30% higher yields under polyhouse conditions.
- Farmers reported ₹50,000–₹70,000 potential income per cycle from 0.25-acre diversified plots.
- 91% of surveyed farmers showed interest in mushroom cultivation; 50% had inputs for vermicomposting.
- All 2,044 trained farmers received ASCI certification, adding value to their knowledge base.

Important Data & Numbers

- 2,500+ Unique Farmers Reached (training + exposure visits)
- 872 Farmers covered under baseline survey
- 75 Demonstration Plots across 60 villages
- 25 Farmer Field Schools with 700 participants
- 30% Water Saving on model farm through drip irrigation
- 64–69% Increase in income on demo plots (Mustard, Chickpea, Garden Pea)
- ₹50–70K Potential Income from 0.25-acre diversified polyhouse plots
- 1,000 kg Vermicompost Output per unit (₹4,200 net profit)

Stories of Change

Pushpa Kumari: A Catalyst for Change

Pushpa Kumari, a smallholder farmer from Dadi village, struggled with declining yields and high fertiliser costs. After attending Harit Samriddhi training, she adopted crop rotation and integrated pest management. Within a single season, her soil health improved, fertiliser use dropped by 25%, and yields rose noticeably. Seeing her success, five other women farmers in the village adopted similar practices, collectively covering 15 acres under improved methods. Pushpa now leads farmer meetings as a peer educator, symbolising the ripple effect of knowledge-sharing that Project Harit Samriddhi aims to create.





Project Samriddhi (PNB MetLife)

Project Samriddhi is a Crop Residue Management (CRM) initiative in Jind district of Haryana aimed at reducing stubble burning and empowering SHGs to create handicrafts from paddy residue. The project reduces stubble burning by linking farmers to service providers, promoting in-situ and ex-situ solutions, and empowering Self-Help Groups (SHGs) to convert parali (paddy residue) into marketable handicrafts. It integrates awareness campaigns, skill-building, and market linkage creation to transform parali from waste into wealth.

Objectives

- Reduce active fire locations (AFLs) by 80–90% across red and yellow villages.
- Enable SHGs to generate alternate livelihoods through parali-based handicraft products.
- Build farmer awareness about CRM practices and service availability.
- Connect farmers with EUIs to monetise crop residue.
- Establish Samriddhi Kaushal Kendra (Skill Center) for production, display, and sale of SHG products.

Major Activities

- Conducted baseline survey with 113 farmers, mapping 77 fire-prone hotspots.
- Facilitated 3,803 farmer linkages with CRM service providers for residue management.
- Organised 80 awareness sessions and 234 FGDs across 20 villages, reaching 4,907 farmers.
- Trained 30 SHG members in advanced handicraft production using parali.
- Set up Samriddhi Skill Center as a hub for training, production, and marketing of eco-friendly products.
- Engaged 4 End-User Industries for sustainable stubble procurement and market linkages.
- Conducted volunteer workshops with PNB MetLife employees, creating lamps and décor from stubble materials.

Location(s)

JHARKHAND, WEST BENGAL



Key Highlights & Outcomes

- 5,000+ tonnes of stubble diverted from burning (worth ~₹1 crore).
- 8 million+ kg GHG emissions avoided, contributing to cleaner air.
- 2 red zone villages converted to yellow, 3 to green; 8 of 10 yellow villages converted to green.
- 30 women empowered through SHG training, now producing saleable handicrafts.
- SHG products showcased at district fairs and corporate events, increasing visibility and demand.
- Villages report significantly reduced farm fires.

Important Data & Numbers

- 3,803 Farmers Linked to service providers
- 20 Villages covered under the program
- 80 Awareness Sessions + 234 FGDs conducted
- 30 SHG Women trained and earning from parali products
- 5,000+ Tonnes Residue saved from burning (₹1 Cr market value)
- 8M+ Kg CO₂ emissions avoided

Stories of Change

The Women of Dalamwala – Turning Waste into Wealth

In Dalamwala village, 20 SHG members trained under Project Samriddhi began producing baskets and mats from parali. These products were displayed at district fairs and sold to urban buyers, generating steady income and reducing open burning in the village.

Renu Devi, a member of a Self-Help Group in Jind, once struggled with limited income opportunities while managing household duties. Through Project Samriddhi, she was trained in creating handicrafts from paddy residue. Today, Renu confidently makes eco-friendly lamps, trays, and décor items at the Samriddhi Skill Center. She sold her products at local exhibitions and even received bulk orders during festivals.





Project Bhoomi

(Chambal Fertilisers)

Project Bhoomi is a flagship climate-smart agriculture initiative under the K.K. Birla Memorial Society CSR program, implemented across Fatehabad, Jind, Sonipat, and Hisar districts of Haryana. The program aims to eliminate crop residue burning through a holistic approach combining farmer sensitisation, crop diversification, Direct Seeding of Rice (DSR) promotion, and farm mechanisation support. By creating strong linkages with service providers and end-user industries, Project Bhoomi builds a self-sustaining ecosystem that benefits farmers economically while improving air quality and soil health.

Objectives

- Reduce greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions and air pollution from stubble burning.
- Facilitate adoption of sustainable practices such as DSR, crop diversification, and CRM.
- Develop rural entrepreneurs to run rental machinery services for timely residue management.
- Connect farmers with End-User Industries (EUIs) to monetise crop residue.
- Build long-term community capacity through campaigns, training, and real-time digital engagement.

Major Activities

- Conducted baseline survey with 1,220 farmers to understand residue management practices.
- Sensitised 36,245 farmers through 244 village-level CRM campaigns and 3 district-level awareness programs.
- Onboarded 1,551 service providers and linked 34,062 farmers for timely stubble management.
- Created 145 WhatsApp groups with Common Service Centres (CSCs) and progressive farmers for real-time support.
- Distributed booklets on CRM, Crop Diversification, and DSR best practices.
- Conducted 246 stakeholder meetings with Agriculture Department officials, Panchayats, FPOs, and Universities to align efforts.
- Facilitated operation of 3 baler sets across Jind (Narwana, Uchana, Safidon) and returned them in working condition to the Agriculture Department.
- Identified 1,505 farmers interested in adopting DSR in the next season and supported 300 farmers to adopt DSR this year.

Location(s)

PUNJAB, HARYANA, RAJASTHAN



Key Highlights & Outcomes

- 36,000+ farmers reached through sensitisation and CRM linkages.
- 1,103 Active Fire Locations (AFLs) identified and addressed through machine mobilisation and awareness campaigns.
- 34,062 farmers connected with service providers, enabling large-scale stubble collection and ex-situ use.
- 300 farmers adopted DSR this Kharif season, paving the way for large-scale adoption in 2025.
- 8 End-User Industries engaged, strengthening the market for crop residue.
- Creation of a robust communication and support ecosystem via 145 WhatsApp groups.

Important Data & Numbers

- 36,245 Farmers Sensitised across 4 districts
- 1,551 Service Providers Onboarded for CRM solutions
- 34,062 Farmer Linkages to service providers & buyers
- 145 WhatsApp Groups formed for real-time support
- 1,103 AFLs mapped & monitored
- 300 Farmers Adopted DSR this season | 1,505 Identified for next year
- 244 Village Campaigns + 3 District-Level Programs conducted

Stories of Change

Ramesh: Championing DSR in Jind

Ramesh, a progressive farmer from Jind district, initially hesitated to try Direct Seeding of Rice due to fear of yield loss. After witnessing results from project-supported demo plots, he rented a machine through the Bhoomi rental network and cultivated his entire 6-acre farm using DSR. He reduced irrigation cycles by 25%, saved on labour costs, and still achieved yields comparable to puddled transplanting. Inspired by his success, 15 neighbouring farmers have committed to adopt DSR next season, demonstrating how one farmer's success can drive community-wide change.





Project Harit Dhara Saaf Vayu (NatWest)

Harit Dhara Saaf Vayu is a multi-year CSR initiative supported by NatWest, implemented across 60 villages in Jind district, Haryana. The program aims to drastically reduce stubble burning, improve air quality, and promote climate-smart agriculture practices such as Crop Residue Management (CRM) and Direct Seeding of Rice (DSR). By combining machine access, input support, farmer sensitisation, and continuous monitoring through the Roots Agri App, the project creates a replicable model for sustainable farming

Objectives

- Reduce Active Fire Locations (AFLs) by 90% by the end of 2025 harvest season.
- Manage crop residue in-situ and ex-situ to prevent burning and restore soil health.
- Promote large-scale adoption of DSR to conserve water, reduce methane emissions, and cut production costs.
- Build local capacity through training, mega farmer events, and IEC campaigns.
- Generate rural employment and strengthen Custom Hiring Centres (CHCs) to ensure access to machinery.

Major Activities

- Managed 10,162.4 hectares under CRM, preventing open burning.
- Diverted 20,325 tonnes of stubble, avoiding significant GHG emissions.
- Conducted 60 DSR demonstration plots across project villages; 41 survived successfully and showed strong results.
- Trained 1,248 farmers in DSR techniques and provided free herbicide and machinery support.
- Linked farmers to CHCs for happy seeders, super seeders, and straw reapers.
- Deployed 30+ rural youth as field mobilizers and created seasonal employment.
- Executed IEC campaigns with wall paintings, banners, and farmer meetings to drive behaviour change.
- Continuously monitored field data via the Roots Agri App to track adoption and AFL reduction.

Location(s)

**TELANGANA, GUJARAT, KARNATAKA, ANDHRA PRADESH,
TAMIL NADU, RAJASTHAN, MADHYA PRADESH**



Key Highlights & Outcomes

- 20,325 tonnes of stubble prevented from burning, directly improving local air quality.
- 28,862 tonnes of CO₂ emissions avoided – a major contribution to climate goals.
- Soil Organic Carbon (SOC) improved from 0.3% to 0.5% in Year 1, strengthening long-term soil fertility.
- Farmers adopting DSR saved an average of ₹3,631 per acre in production costs.
- AFLs have shown a year-on-year decline, with several clusters reporting near-zero burning incidents.
- Strengthened value chain by supporting CHCs, EULs, and service providers to create sustainable CRM infrastructure.

Important Data & Numbers

- 10,162.4 Hectares under CRM management
- 20,325 Tonnes stubble diverted from burning
- 28,862 Tonnes CO₂ avoided
- 60 DSR Plots (41 successful)
- 1,248 Farmers Trained in DSR
- ₹3,631 Cost Saving per acre for DSR adopters
- 30+ Rural Youth engaged in mobilization & field operations

Stories of Change

Kuldeep Singh, a farmer from Bighana village (Alewa block), had to burn stubble last year due to lack of baler operators. Under Project Harit Dhara, he accessed baling services for his 23 acres, preventing residue burning entirely. This inspired him to advocate CRM practices to neighboring farmers. The following season, a cluster of nearby villages reported a dramatic drop in farm fires, showing how access to solutions and peer advocacy can accelerate community-wide adoption.





EKL Basic & Advanced Training

The Escorts Kubota Limited (EKL) Basic & Advanced Training Program is designed to build farmer capacity through structured classroom training and practical, on-field demonstrations. Conducted at the Escorts Kubota Advanced Farming Institute (EKAFI) in Kurukshetra and extended to Ambala, Kaithal, Yamunanagar (Haryana) and Mandya (Karnataka), the program provides farmers with comprehensive knowledge on crop diversification, mechanisation, soil health, animal husbandry, and sustainable practices. The initiative empowers farmers to adopt modern, profitable, and climate-resilient agriculture techniques.

Objectives

- Train farmers in good agricultural practices (GAP), soil testing, crop diversification, farm management, and mechanisation.
- Facilitate third-party assessment and ASCI certification for trained farmers.
- Establish advanced demo plots to showcase improved practices across key crops.
- Provide continuous handholding and agronomic advisory throughout the crop cycle.
- Create a pool of "Champions of Change" farmers to serve as local ambassadors for scientific farming.

Major Activities

- Conducted 133 batches of two-day structured training sessions covering 3,701 farmers.
- Covered 455 villages across 38 tehsils in Kurukshetra & Kaithal districts.
- Delivered additional one-day sensitisation training for 4,343 farmers.
- Facilitated ASCI assessments – 86% of farmers scored 61–80 marks, 13% scored >80 marks.
- Established 257 advanced demo plots (target was 240) across Haryana & Karnataka showcasing wheat, potato, maize, tomato, cabbage, and beans.
- Provided input support (seeds, nutrients, growth promoters) and conducted regular field visits (every 15 days).
- Shared virtual crop advisory weekly via calls/WhatsApp groups.
- Organised farmer exposure visits to model plots and facilitated peer-to-peer learning

Location(s)

PUNJAB, HARYANA



Key Highlights & Outcomes

- Farmers adopting improved practices reported input cost reduction and higher net profitability.
- Wheat demo plots achieved average yield of 22.46 q/acre and ₹44,507/acre profit, with best-case yield of 32 q/acre.
- Potato demos reported 180 q/acre yields, achieving ₹89,250/acre net profit in best cases.
- Tomato and cabbage plots in Karnataka outperformed controls despite market volatility.
- Program achieved 80%+ farmer satisfaction, with majority requesting follow-up advanced training.

Important Data & Numbers

- 3,701 Farmers Trained (2-day course) + 4,343 Farmers (1-day sessions)
- 455 Villages covered in Kurukshetra & Kaithal
- 86% Scored 61–80 in ASCI assessments | 13% Scored >80
- 257 Demo Plots Established (Target 240)
- Avg. Wheat Yield: 22.46 q/acre | Profit: ₹44,507/acre (Best: ₹66,076/acre)
- Potato Best Yield: 180 q/acre | Profit: ₹89,250/acre

Stories of Change

Rajbir, a farmer from Sudhpur village in Kurukshetra, participated in the EKL advanced training program. By following the recommended package of practices — including balanced nutrient application, timely weeding, and improved seed selection — Rajbir achieved a yield of 32 quintals per acre of wheat and net profit of ₹66,076 per acre, well above the local average. His field became a live classroom for neighbouring farmers, many of whom have now enrolled in EKL programs, proving that peer-led demonstration is one of the most powerful tools for agricultural transformation.





Sports

Our initiatives in grassroots sports development help young athletes build foundational skills, access professional training, and showcase their talent through competitive platforms.

 **15,000**
Budding sports persons
trained scientifically

 **150+**
Scouted Students

 **50+**
International/National
-level players

 **10 lakh+**
sqft. of sports infra
under management



Sports not only build better athletes but also better people. It teaches you discipline, focus, and how to fight through struggles — both on the field and in life.”

Milkha Singh (The Flying Sikh)

Why it Matters

India is home to one of the world's largest youth population, with about 65% of its citizens under age 35, making youth development and sports vital to national progression.

Yet, despite this potential, participation in organised sport and physical activity remains low: according to the 2022 India Report Card, many children are not active enough, and organised sport participation is still incomplete.

Furthermore, research shows that participation in sports and having role models reduces school dropout risk among adolescents, highlighting how sports can be a tool for educational engagement and retention.

Sports are a lever for education, equity, confidence, health and community cohesion. When children from underserved communities engage in sport, stay in school, and build life-skills, the ripple effects extend far beyond the playing field.

Our Focus Areas

Our sports-program-approach is structured around these core themes:

- **Talent Identification & Nurturing** – Spotting promising young athletes early and providing ongoing training, mentorship and exposure.
- **Infrastructure Development** – Building or upgrading facilities (fields, courts, equipment, smart training spaces) so grassroots talent can thrive.
- **Promoting Gender Equality in Sports** – Ensuring girls have equal opportunity, resources and encouragement to participate and excel.
- **Career Guidance & Counselling in Sports** – Helping young athletes understand pathways, careers and life beyond sport.
- **Sports Education in Schools** – Embedding structured sports curriculum into schools to build routine, discipline and physical literacy.
- **Capacity Building for Coaches & Trainers** – Developing local coaching talent and training programmes so that quality coaching is available at grassroots.
- **Inclusion & Diversity in Sports Programs** – Reaching children from marginalised backgrounds, differently-abled children, and ensuring sport is inclusive.
- **Hosting Leagues & Tournaments** – Organising competitive but supportive events (e.g., leagues, inter-school tournaments) to motivate, engage and showcase talent.
- **Community Engagement through Sports** – Using sport as a focal point for community mobilisation, family engagement, school connection and local pride.
- **Access to Quality Training & Coaching** – Ensuring rural and underserved children get the same standard of coaching, equipment, and support as urban peers.
- **Sports Advocacy & Policy Support** – Working with education departments, sports authorities and community bodies to integrate sports into school systems and policy.
- **Grassroots Sports Development** – Building sustainable local ecosystems (clubs, local competitions, alumni networks) so that sports continue beyond the project.

Village Champions League (Hisar, Haryana)

The Veer Champions League (VCL) is a pioneering grassroots initiative that leverages sports as a tool to tackle one of the most pressing challenges in Haryana's government schools - high dropout rates, especially after Class 8. Financial pressures often force students to discontinue schooling and support their families, with dropout levels reaching **up to 40% in some schools**.

Launched in October 2024 in partnership with the BC Jindal Foundation, VCL was designed as a **four-month intervention** that combined football and kabaddi tournaments with life skills education and financial incentives. Students from Classes 7 and 8 in two villages, **Kaimri and Mangali**, participated in the league, which not only kept them in classrooms but also equipped them with essential skills in teamwork, financial literacy, and communication. By rewarding performance with cash prizes and linking incentives to school attendance, the project addressed both educational and economic barriers faced by families.

Key Highlights (2024–25)

- **Scale of Implementation:**
 - 4 government schools involved, covering 181 students.
 - 16 teams formed (boys' and girls' football and kabaddi).
 - 72 matches conducted (48 Pilot Phase, 24 Extension Phase).
- **Life Skills Integration:**
 - 96 structured sessions on financial literacy and communication skills delivered before and after matches.
 - Players trained in teamwork, sportsmanship, and discipline.
- **Holistic Support:**
 - Transportation provided to ensure safe access to matches.
 - Nutritious snacks distributed after each game, addressing food insecurity while boosting energy and performance.
 - Professional referees and coaches engaged to ensure fair play and high-quality training.
- **Incentives & Rewards:**
 - Total prize money: ₹8.36 lakhs.
 - Individual rewards: ₹1,000 per student per match (6 top performers).
 - Team rewards: ₹20,000 for winners; ₹15,000 for runners-up.
 - Best player award: ₹20,000.
 - ₹2 lakhs worth of sports equipment distributed across 4 schools.
- **Community Engagement:**
 - Kick-off event at Government Girls Senior Secondary School, Mangali, attended by community leaders, district officials, and parents.
 - Parents expressed gratitude as the program combined education, sports, and financial stability, a rare opportunity for children from economically weaker backgrounds.





Data & Impact

- **Education & Attendance:**
 - 10.5% increase in attendance, rising from 79.5% to 87.9%.
 - Dropout risk reduced significantly among participating students.
- **Economic Empowerment:**
 - ₹4.32 lakhs disbursed directly as match rewards.
 - 58% of rewards were saved by families, supporting long-term financial security.
 - 42% was spent on essentials:
 - 14% on sports equipment.
 - 11% on clothing.
 - 9% on school supplies.
 - 6% on footwear.
 - 2% on dietary supplements.
- **Life Skills Development:**
 - 144 sessions delivered (Pilot + Extension phases).
 - 76% increase in students' understanding of financial literacy and sports culture.
 - Students demonstrated stronger teamwork, communication, and problem-solving.
- **Holistic Development:**
 - Increased enthusiasm for sports across schools.
 - Greater interest in government schools among local families, strengthening the public education system.

Stories of Change

- **Karan – A Passion Reignited:** Karan, a 7th-grade student from Kamari, grew up with a deep love for football but lacked the financial means to pursue it. His father works as a painter, and the family struggled to make ends meet. Through VCL, Karan joined his school's football team and quickly stood out for his dedication. Winning match rewards allowed him to purchase much-needed school supplies and football gear, easing the burden on his family. For the first time, nutritious snacks after matches kept him energised and motivated. Today, Karan not only continues his education but also inspires his peers to take both sports and studies seriously.
- **Romika – A Parent's Perspective:** Romika, a mother from Mangali, shared how VCL transformed her children's lives. With training, equipment, and financial rewards, her children could excel in both academics and athletics. "It's more than sports," she said. "It's a platform for underprivileged kids to dream, achieve, and thrive."
- **Kusum – The Coach's Insight:** As a dedicated coach, Kusum witnessed first-hand the ripple effects of VCL. Students began using their prize money to not only support their own needs but also buy books and supplies for siblings. She observed improved school attendance, greater interest in learning, and rising confidence among students. "It's about nurturing dreams and empowering entire families," Kusum explained.

Challenges & Lessons

Challenges: Ensuring consistent attendance, tracking utilisation of cash rewards, and navigating permissions for cash distribution.

Solutions: Strengthened follow-ups with parents, closer monitoring of financial usage, and stronger coordination with government authorities.

Lessons:

- Financial rewards serve as a powerful motivator for both students and families.
- Integrating career counselling and life skills sessions during school hours could deepen impact.
- A voucher system could be explored to balance immediate family needs with long-term educational goals.

In a region where dropout rates in Class 8 often exceed 40%, the Veer Champions League demonstrates how sports can change trajectories. By blending physical activity, financial incentives, and life skills, the program not only kept children in classrooms but also empowered families, inspired communities, and built a stronger foundation for future learning.



Utkarsh

Centre of Excellence for Sports (Khunti, Jharkhand)

Launched in collaboration with the District Administration of Khunti in January 2024, Project Utkarsh is an ambitious initiative to identify and nurture grassroots sports talent in one of India's most promising but underserved regions. Khunti is known for its natural athleticism, yet young people here have long lacked access to professional training, nutrition, and exposure.

Utkarsh was designed as a residential Centre of Excellence that integrates sports and education, enabling students to pursue athletics without compromising academics. Through scouting trials across six blocks, over 5,000 students were tested, of which 100 promising athletes (36 football, 36 hockey, 28 athletics) were selected and inducted into the program. These students, aged 12–17, now receive daily specialised coaching, nutrition support, career counselling, and exposure to competitive tournaments at the district, state, and national levels.

Key Highlights (2024–25)

Scouting & Selection:

- Trials conducted across 450+ schools, reaching 5,000 students.
- 100 students selected into the residential excellence program, hosted at CM SoE Girls' Campus and SS Boys' Hostel.

Training & Development:

- Daily sessions with professional coaches (1:16 ratio).
- Access to sports kits, equipment, and modern facilities.
- Nutrition plans developed by experts, with regular health monitoring.
- Integrated academic support to ensure education continuity.
- Career counselling sessions (virtual + in-person) conducted by sports professionals.

Exposure & Achievements:

- 27 athletes represented Khunti at the national level.
- 98 athletes competed at zonal and state levels.
- 13 athletes selected for Higher Centres of Excellence, including Eklavya Centres in Khunti and Simdega, and the Sports Authority of India's residential programs.
- Participation in key tournaments:
 1. **18th Jharkhand State Junior Athletics Championship:** Gold in 600m, multiple medals in track and field.
 2. **Khelo Jharkhand Games:** 1 Gold, 3 Silver, 1 Bronze.
 3. **68th National School Athletics Championship:** Students competed in discus throw, 1500m, 3000m run, and 400m.
 4. **Nehru Cup, Major Dhyan Chand Cup, ASMITA League:** Strong performances in hockey, with multiple players advancing to national camps.
 5. **Football Trials:** 2 boys selected for the National Sub Junior Championship in Bangalore; 2 girls represented Jharkhand at the SGFI Nationals in Pune, winning Bronze.
- Exposure visit to JRD Tata Sports Complex, Jamshedpur, to experience professional training environments.



Data & Impact

- 100 students trained intensively under Utkarsh's residential program.
- 5,000 students reached through grassroots scouting trials.
- 27 athletes at national level; 98 at state/zonal level.
- 13 athletes promoted to higher Centres of Excellence.
- Improved physical competency, discipline, and confidence, measured through standardised assessments.
- Enhanced sports culture and youth leadership across Khunti's rural communities.

Stories of Change

- **Sangeeta Marandi – Rising Beyond Limits:** Once running barefoot to school on dirt paths, 16-year-old Sangeeta, daughter of farmers, was selected through Utkarsh trials. With professional coaching, nutrition, and support, she quickly rose to win district and state-level gold medals in the 1500m. Ranked 12th nationally, she now dreams of wearing India's jersey. "For the first time, I felt seen," she says.
- **Jyoti Kumari – From Stones to Medals:** Growing up, Jyoti practised discus throw with rocks in barren fields. Selected into Utkarsh in 2024, she received proper training, equipment, and balanced nutrition. Within months, she won gold at district and block levels and silver at the state championships. "I used to throw stones; now I throw for India," she proudly shares.





Challenges & Lessons

- **Challenges:** Balancing rigorous training with academic commitments; ensuring sustained motivation and health for young athletes from disadvantaged backgrounds.
- **Way Forward:**
 - Extend the program till 2027 to consolidate progress.
 - Continue scouting new talent to maintain a strong pipeline.
 - Strengthen pathways for professional sports careers alongside education.

Utkarsh is a transformative ecosystem. By combining talent scouting, structured training, and holistic development, it positions Khunti as a model district for rural sports excellence. The success of its young athletes is rewriting the narrative of grassroots sports in India: from dusty village fields to national podiums.

Location(s)

JHARKHAND



Sports Lab (Punjab & Haryana)

The Sports Lab initiative, implemented by Roots Foundation with support from Hyundai Motor India Foundation, is a long-term grassroots program that integrates physical fitness, sports training, and holistic youth development. Launched as a pilot and expanded into its extension phase (2024–25), the program operates across 60 government schools in Punjab and Haryana, combining structured morning fitness sessions with evening sports camps. Sports Lab goes beyond just training athletes. It builds discipline, leadership, and life skills among young people, while also creating pathways for talented students to progress into academies, state-level competitions, and even higher Centres of Excellence. The extension phase also added career counselling, physiotherapy support, and nutrition initiatives, making it one of the most comprehensive grassroots sports programs in the region.

Key Highlights (2024–25)

- **Scale & Reach**
 - Reached 9,138+ students (21% above target of 7,500).
 - Conducted 2,131 morning sessions in Haryana and 2,258 in Punjab, with 50,000+ student participations.
 - Held 2,927 evening sessions in Haryana and 3,005 in Punjab, nurturing advanced skills.
- **Talent Identification & Nurturing**
 - 239 talented students (119 Punjab, 120 Haryana) scouted and trained in 15+ sports.
 - 47 students linked to academies for advanced coaching pathways.
- **Sports Achievements**
 - Haryana: 218 district-level, 178 state-level, 90 national-level, and 2 international representations.
 - Punjab: 960 district-level, 246 state-level, 32 national-level achievements.
 - Sports disciplines included athletics, football, handball, hockey, kabaddi, boxing, wrestling, karate, judo, and basketball.
- **Hyundai Roots Olympic 2024**
 - Organised on November 9, 2024, at GSSS Behman Diwana, Bathinda.
 - 160 U-14 athletes competed across football, handball, and athletics.
 - Haryana won 2 golds in football and handball; Punjab secured 1 gold in handball; both states shone in athletics with multiple medals.
- **New Initiatives**
 - Physiotherapy Centre launched by Olympic champion Saina Nehwal to provide rehab and recovery support.
 - Nutrition Support Program (with Feeding India by Zomato) benefited 356 athletes across evening centres with fresh fruits, dry fruits, and seasonal nutrition packs.
 - 121 career counselling sessions conducted by athletes, coaches, and professionals (76 in Punjab, 45 in Haryana).
 - Bilingual newsletters distributed across 11,450 households to deepen community engagement.

Data & Impact

- **Student Fitness & Skills:** Significant improvements recorded in flexibility, balance, coordination, and stamina through 1,803 assessments in Haryana and 4,923 in Punjab.
- **Talent Development:** 13 different sports in Haryana and 15 in Punjab showcased representation at district/state/national levels & Medals won in athletics, handball, football, basketball, wrestling, and karate at state and national events.
- **Value Creation:** Grassroots partnerships mobilised ₹2.23 crore worth of tangible value, including support from government Khel Nurseries, community contributions, and corporate partnerships.
- **Community Trust:** Over 50 letters of appreciation from schools, sarpanches, and sports associations acknowledging Sports Lab's transformative role.

Stories of Change

- **Rajneesh – Road to Recovery:** A baseball player from Hisar, Rajneesh sustained a severe shoulder injury that threatened his future. Through physiotherapy at the Sports Lab Fitness Centre, he regained mobility within days, returned to competitive play, and went on to win Best Performance Medal at a state championship. His journey demonstrates the importance of timely rehab in grassroots sports.
- **Government High School, Satiye Wala (Punjab):** Before Sports Lab, students here rarely played sports. With a dedicated handball coach and proper facilities introduced, participation surged. Within a year, seven students qualified for district-level tournaments, and by 2024, the school secured medals at state events. The pride of the school and village grew, and the sports department officially established a handball unit.
- **Ladwa Village (Haryana):** Sports Lab created a thriving handball culture in Ladwa by providing trainers and equipment. The Panchayat and local philanthropists, inspired by the program, developed a full-fledged sports ground and secured a sports nursery for the village. Many students now have access to job opportunities through sports, proving how community-driven efforts can sustain impact.





Challenges & Way Forward

Challenges: Balancing school hours with evening sports camps, ensuring continuous parental engagement, and tracking scouted talents post-program.

Way Forward:

- Strengthen academy linkages for advanced training.
- Scale the nutrition program across more centres.
- Deepen physiotherapy and injury-prevention services.
- Extend program reach to more districts in Punjab and Haryana.

Sports Lab proves that structured grassroots programs can create a lasting ecosystem for youth development. By combining fitness, competitive training, career guidance, community involvement, and holistic support, it not only produces athletes but also builds healthier, more confident, and future-ready young citizens.

Location(s)

PUNJAB, HARYANA (SOON EXPANDING TO 8 MORE STATES)





Sports for All (Rajasthan & Uttar Pradesh)

Sports for All is a CSR initiative supported by **Honda India Foundation** and implemented by Roots Foundation in partnership with Smile Foundation. Launched in May 2024, the program provides structured physical fitness and sports training in government schools, with the vision that every child, regardless of socio-economic background, deserves access to quality sports opportunities. The program currently operates in **three schools**: Primary School Pali (Greater Noida), Government Girls Senior Secondary School (Tapukara, Rajasthan), and Government Senior Secondary School (Budhi Bawal, Rajasthan). With three dedicated coaches working six days a week, the initiative integrates daily PE classes, evening sports camps, career counselling, and exposure to tournaments, creating an inclusive ecosystem where students can thrive.

Key Highlights (2024–25)

- **Scale & Reach**
 - 150+ students engaged regularly across 3 schools.
 - Structured sessions: 40–50 minutes in-school fitness + 60–120 minutes evening camps.
 - Over 250 engagement days with 54+ hours of weekly coaching.
- **Training & Activities**
 - Warm-up drills, motor skill development, and sport-specific training in athletics, kho-kho, kabaddi, football, and table tennis.
 - Customised modules for each class level (Grades 6–10).
 - Summer and winter sports camps to ensure continuity, with 20% higher skill retention observed during breaks.
- **Career Counselling & Exposure**
 - 5 structured career guidance sessions held for students of Classes 5–9, covering careers in sports coaching, physiotherapy, nutrition, and psychology.
 - 131 students participated in tournaments at block, district, and state levels; 46 qualified for state competitions and 10 reached the national level.
 - Recognition and felicitation of top-performing athletes by district sports associations and school authorities.
- **School & Community Engagement**
 - Coaches actively supported assemblies, PTMs, and cultural events, embedding sports into the school's daily rhythm.
 - Celebrated National Sports Day (Aug 29) with 500+ students, teachers, and parents, including inter-house competitions and roleplays on sports icons.
 - Regular collaboration with principals and teachers strengthened the sustainability of the program within school systems.





Data & Impact

Talent Identification:

- **UPS Pali:** Kho-Kho girls' team won Gold at Nationals; athletics team secured 1 Gold and 1 Silver at national competitions in Chennai.
- **GSSS Budhi Bawal:** Student Jayant won Gold in Boxing at state level and qualified for SGFI Nationals.
- **GSSS Tapukara:** 40+ students represented the school at state-level tournaments across archery, cricket, table tennis, cycling, and hockey.

Skills & Fitness:

- Noticeable improvements in stamina, agility, teamwork, and confidence.
- Baseline and ongoing fitness assessments used to track growth.

Holistic Development:

- Increased discipline, time management, and leadership skills among participants.
- Higher student attendance and focus in academics, attributed to sports integration.
- Expanded awareness of sports as a viable career pathway.

Stories of Change

- **A School Transformed – UPS Pali:** The Headmaster of UPS Pali described how sports re-energised the school: "Students who once hesitated now run to the field with excitement. Their discipline has improved, and they show more focus in class. This program has built stronger children and a stronger school community."
- **Sangeeta – Growing into a Leader:** At GSSS Tapukara, coach Sangeeta transformed sports culture from scratch. From small drills to full-fledged sports days, she became a mentor and role model. "Next year," she says, "I want at least one or two of my students to reach the international level."
- **Jayant Dhandhi – From Village Ring to National Dreams:** Jayant, a 13-year-old from Budhi Bawal, rediscovered his passion for boxing through structured training after losing momentum during the pandemic. Supported by his family and coaches, he won state-level Gold and qualified for National SGFI Boxing Championship 2024. Today, he proudly represents Roots Foundation as a Junior Brand Ambassador, inspiring children across rural India.





Challenges & Way Forward

- **Challenges:**
 - Limited infrastructure, especially at Budhi Bawal.
 - Administrative delays in equipment distribution.
 - Social hesitancy around girls' participation in competitive sports.
 - Seasonal breaks affecting training continuity.
- **Way Forward:**
 - Strengthen infrastructure through community and government partnerships.
 - Hire more female coaches to improve inclusivity.
 - Introduce specialist coaches for identified sports.
 - Expand exposure opportunities through tournaments and field visits.
 - Institutionalise program practices for long-term sustainability.

Sports for All is about inclusion, aspiration, and transformation. By embedding sports into schools and communities, the program is creating confident, disciplined, and ambitious young people who see sports not only as play, but as a pathway to learning, leadership, and livelihood.

Location(s)

PUNJAB, HARYANA (SOON EXPANDING TO 8 MORE STATES)





Education

Our initiatives are empowering future generations through quality education and skill development. Our programs focus on equitable learning opportunities, ensuring that children and youth, especially from underprivileged backgrounds, gain access to the knowledge and skills needed to build a better future.



5,000+

School-going children
benefitted from improved
learning & retention levels



2,000+

Students benefited from
improved infrastructure
across 10+ schools



"Education is the most powerful weapon which you can use to change the world."

Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam



Why it Matters

India's education system has made major strides in access, yet learning outcomes and retention remain pressing challenges. The Annual Status of Education Report (ASER 2023) shows that among 14–18-year-olds, only 57.3% can read a simple English sentence, and just 43.3% can correctly solve a basic division problem, skills expected in elementary school. Dropout rates peak in the secondary grades (Classes 9–10) at 12.6%, and 12.3% among girls, primarily due to academic struggles, lack of engagement, and socio-economic pressures.

The Government's National Education Policy (NEP 2020) identifies Foundational Literacy and Numeracy (FLN), continuous teacher training, and experiential learning as national priorities, urging a shift from rote-based learning to critical thinking and applied skills.

In this context, Roots Foundation's education programs focus on bridging foundational gaps, strengthening school ecosystems, and fostering curiosity, confidence, and creativity among children, ensuring they not only stay in school but also thrive as self-assured learners.

Our Focus Areas

Our sports-program-approach is structured around these core themes:

- **STEM Education** – Strengthening conceptual understanding in Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics through hands-on, inquiry-based activities.
- **Teacher Training** – Building teacher capacity through continuous professional development, mentoring, and practical classroom strategies aligned with NEP 2020.
- **Library Programs** – Encouraging reading fluency, comprehension, and critical thinking through structured reading periods and accessible school libraries.
- **Capacity Building** – Supporting school leaders, educators, and local institutions to sustain improved learning systems and monitoring practices.
- **Children's Parliament (Bal Sansad)** – Empowering students to take leadership roles in school decision-making, peer learning, and community engagement.
- **Critical Thinking** – Encouraging analytical reasoning, debate, and reflection to move beyond rote learning and promote independent thought.
- **Experiential Learning** – Bringing concepts to life through projects, experiments, and field-based learning experiences.
- **Analytical Skills Development** – Fostering logical thinking, data interpretation, and problem-solving to prepare students for higher learning and life skills.
- **Summer Camps** – Reducing learning loss, building confidence, and creating joyful learning environments during school breaks.
- **Skill Development** – Equipping students with essential digital, communication, and employability skills for future readiness.
- **Rural Education** – Addressing rural-specific challenges through contextual pedagogy, local language materials, and parent engagement.
- **Innovative Learning** – Integrating digital tools, gamified content, and creative teaching methods to make classrooms more engaging and inclusive.



Project L.E.A.P

Life & Employability Skills for Adolescents Program

Future-ready students through life skills, career guidance, and financial literacy

Project LEAP is an innovative training program designed to equip school students with the skills and confidence they need to be future-ready. Building on insights from its first two years, the program in 2024–25 introduced financial literacy modules for Grades 9 and 10, alongside curated career guidance content for Grades 8 to 10. Employee engagement was a strong feature this year, with volunteers conducting workshops and seminars for both students and parents.

To ensure meaningful measurement of outcomes, LEAP utilises a mixed-methods monitoring approach combining quantitative assessments with qualitative observations.

Key Highlights (2024–25)

- Integrated financial literacy and career guidance modules across three grades.
- Enhanced English comprehension and speaking confidence among students.
- Observed a shift in decision-making, with students relying more on fact-based analysis rather than instinct or peer pressure.
- Strengthened teamwork and nurtured gender-equitable beliefs.
- Improved clarity around future career choices, especially in Grade 9 students who had received two years of continuous engagement.

Data & Impact

English Competency Tests showed significant improvements:

- Grade 8 students recorded an average 60% improvement, with Reading Comprehension scores more than doubling (+104%).
- Grade 9 students recorded an average 75% improvement, excelling in Grammar (+117%) and Vocabulary (+110%).

Life Skills Assessment Scale (LSAS):

- 55.6% of students rated as Proficient.
- More female students (31.2%) achieved proficiency compared to males (24.5%).
- City-wise, Delhi and Pune outperformed Bangalore in overall proficiency levels.

Situational Case Studies demonstrated practical application of learning:

- Grade 8: ~85% accuracy, strongest in Conflict Resolution and Critical Thinking.
- Grade 9: ~93% accuracy, strongest in Time Management, with areas of growth identified in healthy communication.

Location(s)

NEW DELHI, KARNATAKA,
MAHARASHTRA





Project Utkarsh (Mandya)

Enhancing learning outcomes in rural government schools through FLN, STEM, and digital education

Enhancing learning outcomes in rural government schools through FLN, STEM, and digital education. Project Utkarsh, supported by Acuity Knowledge Partners, is a comprehensive learning enhancement initiative aimed at strengthening foundational literacy and numeracy (FLN), STEM education, and English proficiency in government schools across Mandya, Karnataka. Alongside academics, Utkarsh promotes holistic growth by integrating library sessions, digital learning, and sports. The year's interventions were marked by strong collaboration with local education authorities and teachers. While navigating challenges such as scheduling and government permissions, the team successfully adapted to ensure continuity in classrooms. A key achievement was the increased parental participation in parent-teacher meetings, reflecting stronger school-community partnerships.

Key Highlights (2024–25)

- Reached 870+ students across 6 government schools in 3 blocks.
- Conducted regular Integrated Learning Classes (ILC) for Grades I–VII, along with 5 months of STEM and computer classes.
- Introduced structured library sessions, enhancing reading culture.
- Strengthened sports and physical activities to complement academics.
- Conducted 3 field visits to monitor progress and engage with stakeholders.

Data & Impact

- Over 70% of students showed measurable improvement in learning outcomes.
- Grade III: 77.2% improved; average +8.9% in Maths, +7.1% in English.
- Grade IV: 72.6% improved; average +11.1% in Maths, +10.1% in English.
- Grade V: 68.7% improved; average +11.9% in Maths, +9.9% in English.
- Grade VI: 67.4% improved; average +7.2% in Maths, +8.2% in English.
- Teachers reported positive behavioural changes, increased curiosity in STEM subjects, and stronger engagement during digital learning sessions.

Stories of Change

- **Lathhesh Kumar H.K.:** A 7th grader who overcame emotional and academic struggles after losing his father. Focused English sessions rebuilt his confidence and inspired him to pursue a career in engineering.
- **Varshitha H.T.:** A 4th grader who initially struggled with the alphabet and numbers. With ILC and smart digital tools, she made rapid progress in English and Math, becoming an active and confident learner.

Location(s)

KARNATAKA





Skill Development

Our initiatives are empowering future generations through quality education and skill development. Our programs focus on equitable learning opportunities, ensuring that children and youth, especially from underprivileged backgrounds, gain access to the knowledge and skills needed to build a better future.



15,000+

livihoods positively impacted



5,021

Benefitted by Apparel Made-ups & Home Furnishing Sector Skill Council (AMHSSC), 3,505 placed, 975 candidates were under training



"Skilling is empowering and promotes justice. Women self-help groups have helped in training more than three crore so far."

Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi

Why it Matters

India stands at a demographic crossroads: over 65% of its population is under the age of 35, and nearly 12 million young people enter the workforce every year. Yet, according to the Periodic Labour Force Survey (2023–24), only 4.4% of India's workforce has received formal vocational or technical training, compared to over 70% in countries like South Korea and Germany.

At the same time, unemployment among youth (15–29 years) remains significant at 10.0%, and nearly 42% of graduates are either unemployed or underemployed. (MOSPI, 2024) Many young people, especially women and those in rural areas, lack access to market-linked training, digital skills, and career counselling, leaving a critical mismatch between education and employability.

Skill development is therefore not only an economic imperative but a social one. It is central to building self-reliance, gender equity, and inclusive growth. At Roots Foundation, our programs go beyond short-term training; they equip youth and women with practical, industry-relevant skills, connect them to livelihood opportunities, and help them step into the workforce with confidence and dignity.

Our Focus Areas

- **Vocational Training** – Delivering hands-on courses in trades such as tailoring, embroidery, and technical crafts, aligned to local and regional demand.
- **Capacity Building** – Strengthening institutional and trainer capacities to design and deliver high-quality skill programs with measurable outcomes.
- **Youth Upskilling** – Providing digital literacy, communication, and life skills to enhance employability among young men and women.
- **Women Empowerment** – Enabling women to achieve financial independence through tailored skill courses, entrepreneurship support, and job placements.
- **Skill-Based Employment** – Linking trained candidates to sustainable employment through corporate, MSME, and value-chain partnerships.
- **Job-Oriented Training** – Designing demand-driven curricula focused on marketable trades and emerging sectors such as textiles, hospitality, and digital services.
- **Industry-Linked Skills** – Building partnerships with industries for apprenticeships, live projects, and exposure visits to ensure real-world readiness.
- **Self-Reliance Initiatives** – Supporting micro-entrepreneurship, home-based enterprises, and cooperative production models for income generation.
- **Economic Empowerment** – Enabling individuals and communities to achieve upward mobility by diversifying income sources and promoting savings culture.
- **Livelihood Opportunities** – Creating long-term livelihood pathways by connecting skilled youth and women to local enterprises and social ventures.
- **Emergency Medical Aid** – Integrating basic first-aid and healthcare awareness modules to improve workplace and community safety.



Project Unnati

Empowering women with vocational and entrepreneurial skills for sustainable livelihoods

Project Unnati, supported by Acuity Knowledge Partners, is a flagship skill development program in Gurgaon that trains marginalised women in sewing, embroidery, and pattern-making. Beyond technical skills, Unnati fosters financial independence, confidence, and community building.

Key Highlights (2024–25)

- Established a dedicated training centre with state-of-the-art equipment.
- Conducted two batches of training in sewing and embroidery.
- Mobilised 177 women across communities, enrolling 71 candidates.
- 60 completed training; 27 placed with corporate partners like Divine Design and Ishvar International.
- Celebrated milestones through employee engagement workshops and client visits.
- Initiated an artisan network to facilitate long-term entrepreneurial opportunities.

Data & Impact

- Placement salaries: ₹10,000–12,000 per month.
- 73% course completion rate.
- Rizwana Parvin awarded “Best Candidate,” receiving a sewing machine.
- Artisan network aims to secure ₹25 lakh worth of work orders in Year 1.

Stories of Change:

- **Rizwana – Stitching a New Future:** From trainee to assistant trainer, Rizwana now dreams of starting her own boutique.
- **Jyoti – Story of Resilience:** Despite personal challenges, Jyoti carries her embroidery skills back home to generate income.
- **Urmila – Finding Hope and Dignity:** Widowed early in life, Urmila regained confidence and purpose through Unnati’s training, finding dignity in her daily work.

Location(s)

HARYANA, UTTAR PRADESH, KARNATAKA, JHARKHAND





Community Development

Our initiatives address holistic community development by empowering individuals with education, skill-building, and livelihood opportunities. We work closely with local stakeholders to enhance infrastructure, promote sustainable practices, and create self-reliant communities.



2,000+

beneficiaries were provided with improved access to education and enhanced overall well-being within the community

7 Cr+

Invested



"India today stands at the confluence of three powerful forces - demographic advantage, digital transformation, and a deep developmental commitment. With the world's largest youth population and a vibrant skilling ecosystem, we are uniquely positioned to become the Skill Capital of the World."

Shri Jayant Chaudhary, Minister of State (Independent Charge)
for Skill Development and Entrepreneurship



Why it Matters

Rural India is home to nearly 65% of the country's population, yet it continues to face multidimensional challenges, from limited access to healthcare, education, and sanitation to fragile livelihood systems and climate vulnerability.

According to the NITI Aayog Multidimensional Poverty Index (2023–24), 11.9% of Indians still live in multidimensional poverty, with rural areas accounting for over 20% of the population deprived across indicators such as housing, nutrition, education, and employment.

Despite progress, rural infrastructure gaps remain wide: only 64% of rural households have access to piped water, and roughly 27% lack access to primary healthcare within a 5 km radius. (Ministry of Rural Development & MoHFW, 2024) Limited digital access and weak local governance further constrain inclusion and participation, particularly for women and marginalised groups.

At Roots Foundation, community development means empowering people to design and drive their own progress. By combining social inclusion, livelihood generation, and infrastructure improvement with participatory governance, we help rural communities move from dependency to self-sufficiency, ensuring that growth is holistic, equitable, and sustainable.



Our Focus Areas

- **Sustainable Development** – Promoting environmentally and socially responsible community initiatives that align with long-term sustainability goals (SDGs 1, 5, 6, 8, and 13).
- **Social Inclusion** – Enabling participation of marginalised and vulnerable groups in development processes through awareness, access, and representation.
- **Capacity Building** – Strengthening local institutions, self-help groups (SHGs), and community leaders through training and knowledge-sharing.
- **Infrastructure Development** – Supporting small-scale rural infrastructure such as sanitation, waste management, public spaces, and digital facilities.
- **Livelihood Enhancement** – Facilitating income diversification through agriculture-linked enterprises, vocational training, and micro-entrepreneurship.
- **Rural Upliftment** – Improving quality of life in rural areas through integrated interventions in education, health, and employment.
- **Holistic Growth** – Focusing on interconnected aspects of well-being, from economic stability and education to health, gender equity, and environment.
- **Gender Equality** – Promoting women's participation in leadership, livelihood, and community decision-making processes.
- **Participatory Approach** – Involving local communities at every stage of planning and implementation to ensure ownership and sustainability.
- **Community Engagement** – Encouraging civic responsibility and volunteerism through awareness campaigns, health drives, and collaborative rural events.



CDP – Devanahalli

Holistic rural development through education, healthcare, environment, and infrastructure

Launched in December 2022, the Community Development Project (CDP) in Polanahalli and Cheemachanahalli villages, Bengaluru Rural, seeks to improve the quality of life through a multi-pronged approach. The project integrates education, healthcare, environment and livelihoods, and rural infrastructure, engaging community members at every step.

Key Highlights (2024–25)

- **Education:** Scholarships provided to 30 students, including 4 visually impaired youth. English, computer, and library sessions conducted; Smart TVs and structured library periods introduced.
- **Healthcare:** Clinics operational 6 days a week, treating 1,354 patients, including 10 dengue cases during an outbreak.
- **Livelihoods:** 4 animal health camps benefited 100+ farmers with vaccinations and deworming.
- **Infrastructure:** 8 stainless steel dustbins installed and the Cheemachanahalli bus stand renovated.
- **Digital Literacy:** Workshops on MS Word, PowerPoint, and internet skills conducted for students.

Stories of Change

Devaraj – A Journey of Determination: A visually impaired student receiving a scholarship of ₹10,000, Devaraj is preparing for competitive exams with renewed confidence. His story of resilience has inspired peers and community members, showing how equal opportunities enable young people to pursue their aspirations.

Location(s)

RAJASTHAN AND KARNATAKA





CDP – Hosur

Expanding community transformation through education, healthcare, and livelihoods

Expanding community transformation through education, healthcare, and livelihoods. Initially a school transformation and healthcare program in 2021, CDP Hosur has now grown into a community-wide initiative across Krishnagiri, Tamil Nadu. In its third year, the project addressed infrastructure gaps in schools, improved healthcare access, supported livelihoods, and promoted environmental awareness.

Key Highlights (2024–25)

- **Education:** 900+ students benefitted from awareness sessions and infrastructure upgrades across 4 schools. Facilities included renovated toilets, incinerators for sanitary waste, an RO plant for clean drinking water, and paver block roads.
- **Healthcare:** 250+ residents accessed free medical and dental camps. Equipment provided to PHCs enhanced service delivery.
- **Livelihoods:** 12 SHG women trained in poultry management, each receiving 20 chicks and feed, with expected income gains of ₹40,000 annually.
- **Infrastructure & Sanitation:** Improved road connectivity for 1,000+ commuters; garbage vehicle donated; 3 dustbins installed; employee-led cleanliness drives conducted.

Stories of Change

Beeramma – Empowering Women through Poultry: As part of an SHG, Beeramma joined the poultry training program and immediately applied her skills. With resources provided, she now supplements her family's income significantly, and her success is motivating other women to step into entrepreneurship.

Location(s)

RAJASTHAN AND KARNATAKA





PARTNERSHIPS AND COLLABORATIONS

At Roots Foundation, partnerships are the cornerstone of every initiative we undertake. We believe that sustainable impact is achieved when communities, corporations, governments, and knowledge institutions work together toward shared goals. Over the years, we have partnered with leading corporate organisations, public sector bodies, and development experts who share our commitment to inclusive, scalable, and measurable impact.

TATA TRUSTS

KKBMS

सेंट्रल कोलफील्ड्स लिमिटेड
Central Coalfields Limited
(A subsidiary of Coal India Limited)



HONDA

HYUNDAI

EXIDE

**NatWest
Group**

ACUITY
KNOWLEDGE PARTNERS

Farlense

Cummins
Under CSR Initiative

Kubota
Escorts Kubota Limited
EKL CSR Foundation
(Wholly owned subsidiary of Escorts Kubota Limited)

PI
Foundation

Jindal
TRADE MARK

**Futures
First**

pnb MetLife
Million life aage badhkar

Smile
FOUNDATION

fdi

Aster
We'll Treat You Well

**Samhita
CGF**

feeding india
by **zomato**

and many more..

Media & Recognition

Roots in News



Governance

Team

Roots Foundation is led by a diverse and dedicated team that combines youthful energy with seasoned experience. What makes our team unique is that no two people share the same background, qualification, or skillset. Each member brings a distinct perspective shaped by different disciplines, geographies, and lived experiences. This diversity fuels innovation, empathy, and adaptability across all our programs.

Our governance structure ensures transparency and accountability at every level. The Core Leadership Team and Board of Advisors provide strategic direction, while state and field teams drive on-ground execution with precision and purpose.



Ridhima Bahuguna



Ritwik Bahuguna



Vijay Singh



A.P. Sinha



Trapti Moonat



Vikas Gupta



Anirudh Singare



Sonia Singh



Anmol Pandey

Looking Ahead to 2025-2026

As we move into the next year, Roots Foundation's focus is on deepening impact and expanding reach. Building on the strong foundation of our ongoing programs,

our priorities for FY 2025–26 include:

Scaling Up Existing Programs: Expanding the footprint of ongoing initiatives across new districts and states, ensuring wider adoption of proven models.

Increasing Beneficiary Reach: Within existing geographies, we aim to significantly increase the number of farmers, students, athletes, and women beneficiaries through intensified training, capacity building, and partnerships.

Geographic Expansion: Extending our presence to new states: Odisha, Rajasthan, Maharashtra, Gujarat, West Bengal, and the North-East (Sikkim, Manipur), to build regional ecosystems of sustainable development.

Strengthening Systems: Continuing to enhance our monitoring and evaluation frameworks, digital tracking systems, and community feedback mechanisms for greater transparency and efficiency.

Deepening Partnerships: Expanding our partnerships with corporates, state governments, CSR partners, and technical agencies to co-create programs that can be institutionalised within public systems for long-term sustainability.

Our vision for the coming year is clear - to take our tested models to scale, while ensuring that every new partnership and every new geography reflects the same values that define us: co-creation, community leadership, and measurable impact.

Testimonials

This is what our clients have to say about us



Ashok Desai

Lead EKL CSR Foundation

On behalf of EKL CSR Foundation, we express our profound appreciation for the outstanding contributions of Roots Foundation in the agriculture training and skill development for farmers. Roots Foundation has been an essential training partner, educating farmers through basic training programs and advanced training in different states.



Shri. Lokesh Mishra

Deputy Commissioner, Khunti

Utkarsh: Centre of Excellence for Sports, a collaboration between the Khunti District Administration and Roots Foundation, offers world-class training to young athletes. Despite being new, it has delivered exceptional results, enabling students to compete in prestigious tournaments like the Nehru Cup. The dedication of the coaches and the quality of training are commendable, ensuring these athletes will bring pride to Khunti in the future.



Saina Nehwal

Indian Badminton Player and
Olympic Medalist

This initiative (The Sports Lab Initiative) demonstrates a keen understanding of the needs of sportspersons, providing them with essential resources such as this fitness centre in Hisar. This program will go a long way in ensuring a budding athlete gets everything he needs - training, equipment, fitness lessons and recovery protocols.



Saurabh Sharma

General Manager
CSV HMIL

The professionalism, dedication, and expertise Roots brought to the initiatives made a significant difference, and we truly value the synergy we built. Sports Lab is a unique project where Roots Foundation has served as our partner from concept to the implementation stages, also creating measurable impact on the ground.



Recognitions

Our efforts have been appreciated time and again.



'Leaders of Social Change Award'
Sustainable Agricultural Practices in Rice Cultivation - Direct Seeded Rice (DSR)

India Impact Summit 2021



'Best Non-Profit in grassroots Sports Development of the Year 2023'
Project Sports Lab

Indian CSR Awards 2023



'Reaching the Unreached'

INDIA donates, 2023



'The BCC&I Social Leadership Award'
School Transformation & Healthcare Project

BCC&I Social Conclave, 2nd Edition



'Promotion of Sports' Social Impact Conference & Award (SICA)

TheCSRUniverse, 2024



'The BCC&I Social Leadership Award Community Development

BCC&I Social Conclave, 3rd Edition



Exemplary Implementation Partner
Project Bhoomi

Chambal Fertilizers & Chemicals Ltd. (CFCL), Samvartika 7th Edition 2023



'Outstanding Contribution to Social Consciousness Award'

World CSR Day, North India Leadership Awards, 2024

Recognitions

Our efforts have been appreciated time and again.



India Impact Summit 2021



Indian CSR Awards 2023



INDIA donates, 2023



BCC&I Social Conclave, 2nd Edition



**Chambal Fertilizers & Chemicals Ltd. (CFCL),
Samvartika 7th Edition 2023**



**World CSR Day, North India
Leadership Awards, 2024**



TheCSRUniverse, 2024



BCC&I Social Conclave, 3rd Edition

Let's collaborate to drive measurable impact together.

We are committed to being a research-driven implementation organisation. By combining data, expertise, and grassroots action, we create sustainable change where it matters most.



Roots Foundation India



india.rootsfoundation



Roots Foundation

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